



Barrio Legado

INTERVIEW PLAYBOOK

INTRODUCTION

Interviewing candidates can be an exciting but often stressful experience, with the undeniable pressure of making the right choice. The prospect of welcoming fresh talent into the team brings a powerful energy, as each new hire has the potential to contribute unique perspectives, diverse insights, and a wealth of experiences. They can help reinvigorate our workplace culture and drive innovation, enhancing our collective success.

Yet, with that excitement comes the undeniable pressure of making the right choice. Interviews provide just a snapshot of a candidate's skills and potential, leaving us to sift through their resumes and responses to find the perfect match. To navigate this, we've crafted a thoughtful system of tailored questions that align with our core values and mission, ensuring we look beyond the surface. This approach transforms the interview into a meaningful exchange, allowing both parties to connect on a deeper level.



BUILDING OUR DREAM TEAM

At Barrio Legado, we believe in hiring with intention, recognizing that the real challenges in recruitment often stem from unclear expectations and hasty decisions rather than a shortage of qualified candidates. We're not just looking for someone who's "nice" or has a shiny resume; we want individuals who resonate with our core values, enhance our vibrant culture, and are eager to grow alongside us. It's all about seeking out the right mindsets - those who are curious, resilient, coachable, and adaptable. After all, we're not merely filling positions; we're cultivating a passionate team that will help shape and elevate our brand for years to come!

THE HIRING FLOW

STAGE	ACTION	WHAT YOU ARE EVALUATING
RESUME REVIEW	Review all resumes that have been submitted.	Experience. How often they change jobs. Teamwork activities. Presentation.
PRE SCREEN	Call candidate for a quick chat or send professional email.	Professionalism. Tone. Curiosity.
INTERVIEW	Conversation driven questions.	Core Values. Emotional intelligence. Composure.
OPTIONAL SECOND INTERVIEW	Position Based.	Problem-Solving. Initiatives. Team Chemistry.
DECISION	Use red/green flag method.	Long-term value. Mindset. Alignment. Team needs.

When it comes to evaluating candidates, embracing a variety of contact and interaction methods can make all the difference! By mixing things up, we're able to shine a spotlight on different traits at each stage of the process. This approach not only keeps things interesting but also allows us to tailor our assessments to specific qualities, ensuring we get a well-rounded view of each candidate. It's all about finding that perfect fit, and by focusing on distinct traits throughout our evaluation journey, we can make smarter, more confident hiring decisions.





INTERVIEW PRINCIPLES

When conducting interviews, it's essential to be thoroughly prepared, as we want this experience to be positive and inviting for candidates, who are also deciding if they want to join our team. We want to show up with a positive mindset and diligently apply our interview principles to evaluate them to the best of our ability!

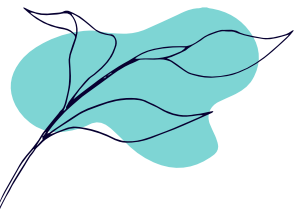
- Be fully present and actively listen.
- Ask follow up questions to gain deeper insight.
- Do not follow a script. Let it flow naturally.
- Have different people conduct different stages to minimize bias.
- Use same set of questions to best evaluate candidates fairly.
- Encourage genuine conversation.
- Explain expectations for the position clearly.
- Take detailed notes.
- Allow for silences to see the candidate's composure.
- Ask if they have any questions to show their interest and values.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

When evaluating candidates, we must learn to recognize the signals of long-term potential, not just their current skillset.

- Look for curiosity, humility, and their eagerness to grow. Skills can be taught, willingness cannot.
- Look to see if they stay steady or resourceful when under pressure. Change exposes character. Those who handle pressure well tend to be flexible and adaptable.
- How well do they accept feedback? One's ability to take feedback is key for their development, showing their coachability.
- Look for someone with warmth, showing a positive demeanor.





GREEN FLAGS V.S RED FLAGS

When hiring, recognizing green flags like open communication and respect for boundaries can lead to hiring amazing people, while being aware of red flags like manipulation and dishonesty can help you steer clear of toxic situations. It is important to trust your instincts. If you walk out of an interview feeling unsure about a candidate, it is a no. Trust that gut feeling knowing great candidates do not make you question your instincts.

Green Flags

- Real, specific stories
- Ownership over actions
- Natural pauses and has a calm tone
- Shows curiosity about the business and team
- Genuine emotion
- Shows a pattern of positive behaviour
- Open to being challenged
- Appreciates different working styles
- Has self-regulation strategies and system for multi-tasking
- Sees opportunities not burdens

Red Flags

- Vague or rehearsed answers
- Places blame or gives excuses
- Defensive or passive-aggressive
- Focus on money, perks, or shortcuts
- Entitlement
- Makes things and situations personal
- Views others needs as an annoyance
- Unrealistic expectations
- Lacks self-awareness
- Speaks poorly about others



PRESCREEN WORKSHEET

Candidate Name:	Date:
Screened By:	Position Applied For:

1. What do you look for in a good employer?

2. What kind of environment brings out your best work?

3. Do you have any questions about the position or the company?

4. What is your availability? How many shifts are you looking for?

Monday _____
Tuesday _____
Wednesday _____
Thursday _____

Friday _____
Saturday _____
Sunday _____
of Shifts _____

Green Flags

Red Flags

Have we vetted them on social media for professionalism?

Instagram ☐

Facebook ☐

Tiktok ☐

Is this candidate qualified to move forward? _____

Next interview: _____

GENERAL INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Candidate Name:	Date:
Interviewed By:	Position Applied For:

1. What is your interest in coming to work with us?

2.What is your favourite quality about yourself?

3.Which of our core values resonates the most with you? Why?

4. Walk me through the last time you completely screwed something up. What happened and what did you do about it? *follow up: what would you do differently now?*

5.If you could only be known for one thing by your co-workers, what would it be? *follow up: why is that important to you? Give an example of when you demonstrated that.*

6.What is the hardest piece of feedback you have ever received? How did you overcome it?

HOST INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Candidate Name:	Date:
Interviewed By:	Position Applied For:

1.What is something that you are proud of that won't show up on a resume?

2.Who is someone that you admire? Why?

3.Can you tell me about a time where your communication skills solved a conflict?

4.How would you handle a situation where a guest demands to be seated right away even though there is a one hour wait?

5.A table arrives 30 minutes late for their reservation, but you have already given the table away. What do you do?

6.A guest calls you over to complain about their experience. What do you do?

Green Flags

Red Flags

Barrio Legado

SERVER ASSISTANT INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Candidate Name:	Date:
Interviewed By:	Position Applied For:

1.What is something that you are proud of that won't show up on a resume?

2.Who is someone that you admire? Why?

3.Tell me about a time when you had to follow strict guidelines or procedures. How did you ensure you were following them correctly?

4.How do you decide what to prioritize when you have multiple tasks?

5.Tell me about a time when you kept going even though you were overwhelmed.

6.A guest calls you over to complain about their experience. What do you do?

Green Flags

Red Flags



Barrio Legado BARTENDER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Candidate Name:	Date:
Interviewed By:	Position Applied For:

1. You notice a regular looks upset but they haven't complained. You are slammed. What do you do? *follow up: what if your manager told you to focus other tables? How do you decide what to prioritize?*

2. What was the best dining experience you ever had? What did they do differently than other restaurants?

3. Our busiest, most chaotic shift is happening/ Everything is going wrong. What do you need from me as your manager in that moment? *follow up: What if I can't give you that in the moment? What if I wasn't there?*

4. Food, service, and atmosphere are the three pillars of hospitality. What do you think is the most important? why?

5. Tell me about your previous manager. What made them great and what made them difficult? What did you learn from them?

6. What is your favourite classic cocktail?

Green Flags

Red Flags

SERVER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Candidate Name:	Date:
Interviewed By:	Position Applied For:

1.What is the difference between service and hospitality?

2.What is the best dining experience you ever had? What did the restaurant do differently than others?

3. Tell me about your previous manager. What made them great and what made them difficult? What did you learn from them?

4.Our busiest, most chaotic shift is happening/ Everything is going wrong. What do you need from me as your manager in that moment? *Follow up: What if I can't give you that in the moment? What if I wasn't there?*

5. You have food at the pass, a table that needs to be greeted, and a table waiting to pay. What do you do?

6. Tell me about a time when you went above and beyond for a guest. *follow up: What was their reaction? What was your manager's reaction?*

Green Flags

Red Flags

Barrio Legado

DISHWASHER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Candidate Name:	Date:
Interviewed By:	Position Applied For:

1. What is something that you are proud of that won't show up on a resume?

2. Who is someone that you admire? Why?

3. Tell me about a time when you had to follow strict guidelines or procedures. How did you ensure you were following them correctly?

4. How do you decide what to prioritize when you have multiple tasks?

5. How do you stay focused and careful while maintaining efficiency?

6. Tell me about a time a coworker took their frustrations out on you? How did you handle it?

Green Flags

Red Flags

LINE COOK INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Candidate Name:	Date:
Interviewed By:	Position Applied For:

1. What is your favourite station to work? Why

2. What do you do when you run out of the ingredients for a dish that has already been ordered?

3. How do you maintain a positive attitude and motivate yourself when confronting challenging situations such as long days, menu changes, or unexpected delays?

4. What is your process for an order with an allergy?

5. Our busiest, most chaotic shift is happening/ Everything is going wrong. What do you need from me as your manager in that moment? *Follow up: What if I can't give you that in the moment? What if I wasn't there?*

6. What chefs do you look to for inspiration? Who is the most influential chef you worked for?

Green Flags

Red Flags

FINAL THOUGHT

When it comes to building our dream team, we are crafting a vibrant culture that reflects our vision and values. Our ideal team doesn't simply appear out of nowhere; it's a masterpiece that together we design with intention and care. Once we have brought talented people on board, the real magic happens as you nurture and develop their skills and strengths. A thriving culture isn't just a happy accident; it's something we cultivate purposefully, creating an environment where everyone feels valued and inspired to contribute their best. By nurturing their skills and creating a supportive environment, we can cultivate a strong culture that thrives on purpose and passion.